



A reconstruction of Jamestown, the first permanent English settlement in North America, established in 1607 on the James River in what is now Virginia.

“THE FIFTEENTH DAY OF JUNE, WE HAD BUILT AND FINISHED OUR FORT... THIS COUNTRY IS A FRUITFUL SOIL, BEARING MANY GOODLY AND FRUITFUL TREES...”

George Percy, English colonist, from *Jamestown Narratives*

IN DECEMBER 1605, PORTUGUESE NAVIGATOR Pedro Fernández de Quiros received royal approval for a second voyage across the Pacific in search of the presumed southern continent, *Terra Australis Incognita*. After sailing through the Tuamotu Archipelago in February 1606, he reached the New Hebrides in May, but was swept out to sea by the trade winds and forced to return to New Spain. The expedition had a second ship, under the command of **Luis Váez de Torres**. Continuing to the west, he discovered the strait that bears his name between **New Guinea** and **Australia**, sighting the continent in the process. In the event, his discoveries, meticulously noted but never published, would not be followed up by Spain. It was left to the Dutch to confirm the existence of Australia.

On May 4, 1607, the **first permanent English settlement** was established in **North America**. **Jamestown**, in present-day Virginia, was a highly speculative venture, financed by the London Company (later the Virginia Company). It was intended

partly to forestall Spanish, French, and Dutch attempts at settlement, and more particularly to locate a sea passage to East Asia, as well as to prospect for gold and other precious metals. Its early years were unpromising. The site, chosen principally because it was easily defended, was swampy, malarial, and had little arable land. The colonists succumbed to disease and starvation, and relations with the **Powhatan Indians** were tense as well. It was only in 1612, when the **first tobacco crop** was exported, that the colony looked to have any prospects of survival.

Torres Strait Islanders mask
The sea-faring Torres Strait Islanders had a range of masks for ritual occasions, many of the most elaborate made from turtle shells.



country, its aim in part to claim Orthodox Russia for the Catholic church. With Godunov's death, the interlopers placed on the Russian throne a man claiming to be Ivan the Terrible's youngest son. After less than a year, this False Dimitri was overthrown by **Vasili IV** (1552–1612), who slaughtered the Poles in Moscow, perhaps 2,000. Seeking to strengthen himself against continuing Polish agitation, in 1609 Vasili allied with Sweden, provoking an official Polish declaration of war against Russia. The following year, the **Poles had taken Moscow** and their king, **Sigismund III**, asserted

his own right to the Russian throne. Alarmed at the prospect of Poland–Lithuania taking over Russia, the **Swedes invaded and captured Novgorod**. In 1612, **Russia was saved** when a patriotic rising under Prince Pozharsky forced the Poles out of Moscow and elected the **first Romanov czar, Mikhail** (1596–1645). Though unable to oust the Swedes, Russia came to terms with Sweden in 1617 at the cost of giving up its access to the Baltic. In 1619, the **Polish–Russian conflict was ended** by Russia ceding substantial territories on its western border.

In Strasbourg in 1605, **Johann Carolus** (1575–1634) published what is generally acknowledged as **the world's first newspaper**, *Relation aller Fürnemmen und gedenckwürdigen Historien*—

“Collection of all Distinguished and Commemorable News.” Carolus already produced a hand-written news-sheet. He realized, however, that a printed version, sold more

cheaply and to a wider audience, would be more profitable. By 1617, there were a further four German newspapers.

The hopes of James I of England for religious toleration were dashed with the discovery on November 5, 1605 of a **Catholic plot to blow up the Houses of Parliament**. It is possible that the plotters were encouraged by Robert Cecil, chief minister of James I, in order to stoke anti-Catholic opinion.



First newspaper on sale
The appearance of the *Relation in Europe* in 1605 was early evidence of a growing demand for information in a fast-changing world.

April 23, 1605
Death of Boris Godunov, Czar of Russia (born c. 1551)

October 15, 1605
Death of Mughal Emperor Akbar I (b. 1542)

November 5, 1605
Catholic conspirator **Guy Fawkes** attempts to blow up English Houses of Parliament

1605
Port Royal, a French colony in Nova Scotia, established

1605
Polish–Lithuanian invasion of Russia

1605
Dutch take Moluccas, East Asia, from Portugal

1605
First newspaper published by Johann Carolus in Strasbourg, Germany

January 31, 1606
Execution of gunpowder plot conspirator **Guy Fawkes** (b. 1570)

February 1606
Dutch navigator **Willem Janszoon** lands on north Australian coast

April 12, 1606
Union Jack adopted as national maritime flag of Great Britain

May 19, 1606
Vasili IV becomes Czar of Russia

November 11, 1606
Treaty of Zsitvatorok ends Habsburg–Ottoman Long War

December 26, 1606
William Shakespeare's play *King Lear* first performed

1606
Spanish navigator **Luis Váez de Torres** explores strait between New Guinea and Australia

May 14, 1607
Jamestown, Virginia, becomes first permanent English settlement in North America

1607
Mughal emperor **Jahangir** sends envoy to Portuguese in Goa, India